

Dear students,

Having gone through many student reports over the years, I wanted to make some general suggestions that I believe you should take into account in completing your lab assignments:

1. Always add captions in your figures and your tables. How do you expect your reader to follow your text otherwise?
2. Always check your text for typos, grammar and syntax problems. Do not be lazy in writing your report. This is telling of your character and feels disrespectful for your reader(s).
3. Always answer exactly to the questions asked, e.g., when the question is "what is the performance gain of the GPU over the CPU?", you should not answer "much". You should answer with a quantity, e.g., "2.7 times faster". Being attentive to the question asked and the answer you give is already one of your most important skills not only in an academic career but also in any other line of work. Trust me.
4. Always do your best in achieving a goal - in this case, making the lab experiments. For instance, if your computer does not have a GPU or the computer room you tried is not available, either look around for another computer room (you are bound to be lucky at the end) or come to the tutor (in this case: me) and ask for help. Again, the tenacity with which you pursue your goals is telling of your personality and character (e.g., also during a general internship or a job interview). Filling in answers like "I could not find a computer for my experiments, thus I did only half" definitely does not entitle you to a 5-out-of-10 mark. I did give all of you passing grades for such cases trying to give credit for overall presentation etc. But I think at the end, it's your loss, as you did not learn in practice what I taught you. As a result, good students among you would have failed the course if I were too strict in grading your reports.
5. Although I appreciate a funny report as much the next man, try to hand in reports that are unemotional and to the point. This is especially important when submitting scientific reports (theses, white papers, publications etc.). Your document should not be verbose, should mention facts - not opinions (unless asked for) - and should be to the point. When writing scientific reports, avoid writing in "essay mode" or literature, as it is tiring for the reader who is looking for facts, not interesting narratives.
6. Disclose the usage of LLMs in your work. This includes using LLMs to help with coding the assignments or editing and refining the language of your report. No points will be deducted for fair usage of LLMs. However, note that coding or reporting the **entire** assignment with AI/LLMs is prohibited. Please refer to the lecture slides for specific policy on using LLMs for lab assignments.

Best regards,

Christos